

2026 Korea-Finland Chip Design Symposium



When:

Friday, September 11, 2026
13:00 ~ 18:00
Saturday, September 12, 2026
09:00 ~ 13:00



Organizer:
Prof. Kwantae Kim
Aalto University, Finland



Where:

Aalto University
Odeion, Maarintie 8, 02150 Espoo, Finland

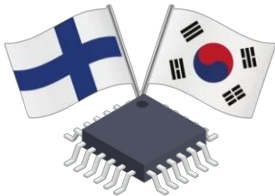


Host:

Embassy of the Republic of Korea in Finland
Aalto University
Aalto Microelectronics Research Center (METKA)

Speakers

Speaker	Affiliation	Title	Country
Jussi Rynnänen	Aalto University	Professor	 Finland
Kimmo Koli	Aalto University	Research Fellow	 Finland
Mikko Varonen	VTT	Senior Scientist	 Finland
Abrar Akram	Tampere University	Assistant Professor	 Finland
Praveen Buddireddy	Nokia	-	 Finland
Markus Hienkari	Bosch Sensortec	Senior Expert	 Finland
SangEun Park	Spinverse	Project Manager	 Finland
Jae-Yoon Sim	POSTECH	Professor	 South Korea
Woo-Seok Choi	Seoul National University	Associate Professor	 South Korea
Woo-Jun Choi	Yonsei University	Assistant Professor	 South Korea
Minyoung Song	DGIST	Associate Professor	 South Korea
Taekwang Jang	ETH Zurich	Associate Professor	 Switzerland
Inhee Lee	University of Pittsburgh	Assistant Professor	 USA
Soyeon Um	MIT	Postdoc	 USA
Sohmyung Ha	New York University Abu Dhabi	Associate Professor	 UAE



This event is funded in part by the Ministry of Foreign Affairs, Republic of Korea

Biography



Prof. Kwantae Kim, Aalto University, Finland

[🏠 Link](#)

Organizer

Kwantae Kim received B.S., M.S., and Ph.D. degrees in the School of Electrical Engineering, KAIST, South Korea, in 2015, 2017, and 2021, respectively. He is an Assistant Professor at the Department of Electronics and Nanoengineering, School of Electrical Engineering, Aalto University, Finland. He was a Visiting Student in 2020, and a Postdoctoral Researcher from 2021 to 2023, at the Institute of Neuroinformatics, University of Zurich and ETH Zurich, and an Established Researcher from 2023 to 2024, at the Department of Information Technology and Electrical Engineering, ETH Zurich, Switzerland. His research interests include analog/mixed-signal ICs and full-custom memory ICs for intelligent audio systems, biomedical sensors, and flexible chips.



Prof. Jussi Ryyänen, Aalto University, Finland

[🏠 Link](#)

[Talk Title TBD]

Jussi Ryyänen received the D.Sc. degree in electrical engineering from the Helsinki University of Technology, Espoo, Finland, in 2004. He is currently a full professor and the Dean of the School of Electrical Engineering, Aalto University. He has authored or co-authored more than 200 refereed journal and conference papers in analog and RF circuit design. He is currently SG Member for the European Solid-State Circuits Conference (ESSCIRC) and the IEEE Nordic Circuits and Systems Conference (NORCAS). He has served as TPC member of IEEE ISSCC and ESSCIRC.

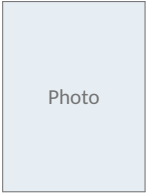


Markus Hienkari, Bosch Sensortec, Finland

[🔗 Link](#)

[Talk Title TBD]

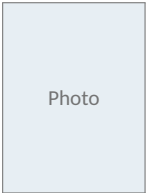
Markus Hienkari received the M.Sc. degree in computer science from Aalto University in 2013. He was with Aalto University and the University of Turku until 2015, researching ultra low-power digital circuit design and system-level energy optimization through co-operation of hardware and software. He has authored or co-authored over ten papers or conference contributions. He is currently working at Bosch Sensortec as an ASIC Architect on low-power consumer MEMS sensors.



Dr. Kimmo Koli, Aalto University, Finland

[Talk Title TBD]

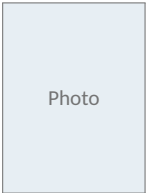
[Bio TBD]



Dr. Mikko Varonen, VTT, Finland

[Talk Title TBD]

[Bio TBD]



Praveen Buddireddy, Nokia, Finland

"Pre-Silicon Power-Thermal Estimation Flows/Methodology for SoC"

[Bio TBD]



SangEun Park, Spinverse, Finland

"Connecting Korean and European Semiconductor Innovation: The Chips Ecosystem, Chips JU, and Opportunities for Collaboration"

SangEun Park is a Project Manager at Spinverse, Finland, where she supports the preparation and management of collaborative European R&D and innovation projects. Her work focuses on Horizon Europe and Chips Joint Undertaking initiatives, with particular emphasis on consortium building, proposal development, and international collaboration in semiconductor and digital technology domains. She has extensive experience connecting Korean and European research and innovation ecosystems and supporting organisations in developing strategic partnerships for future technologies.



Prof. Taekwang Jang, ETH Zurich, Switzerland

[🏠 Link](#)

"PLL-XO Codesign for Energy-Efficient and Ultra-Low Noise Frequency Synthesis"

Taekwang Jang received his B.S. and M.S. in electrical engineering from KAIST, Korea, in 2006 and 2008, respectively. In 2017, he received his Ph.D. from the University of Michigan. From 2008 to 2013, he worked at Samsung Electronics Company Ltd., Yongin, Korea. Currently, he is an associate professor at ETH Zürich and is leading the Energy-Efficient Circuits and Intelligent Systems group. His research focuses on circuits and systems for highly energy-constrained applications such as wireless sensor nodes and biomedical interfaces. Essential building blocks such as a sensor interface, energy harvester, power converter, communication transceiver, frequency synthesizer, and data converters are his primary interests. He received several awards from ISSCC and VLSI, including the 2024 IEEE SSCS New Frontier Award. He served as a TPC member for the ISSCC, an associate editor for the JSSC, and a distinguished lecturer for the SSCS.



Prof. Sohmyung Ha, New York University Abu Dhabi, UAE

[🏠 Link](#)

"Low-Power Architectures and Techniques for Bioimpedance Measurement"

Sohmyung Ha received the B.S. (summa cum laude) and the M.S. degrees in Electrical Engineering from KAIST, Daejeon, Korea, in 2004 and 2006, respectively. From 2006 to 2010, he worked as an integrated circuit designer at Samsung Electronics. He then returned to academia as a Fulbright Scholar and earned the M.S. and Ph.D. degrees in Bioengineering from the University of California, San Diego, La Jolla, CA, USA, where he received the Engelson Best Ph.D. Thesis Award in Biomedical Engineering. Since 2016, he has been with New York University Abu Dhabi, Abu Dhabi, UAE, where he is currently an Associate Professor of Electrical Engineering and Bioengineering.

He currently serves as an Associate Editor of the IEEE Open Journal of the Solid-State Circuits Society and previously served as an Associate Editor of the IEEE Transactions on Biomedical Circuits and Systems. He is a member of the Analog Signal Processing Technical Committee (ASP TC) and the Biomedical and Life Science Circuits and Systems Technical Committee (BioCAS TC) of the IEEE Circuits and Systems Society (CASS). He previously served on the International Technical Program Committee (ITPC) of the IEEE International Solid-State Circuits Conference (ISSCC) and is currently the Technical Program Committee (TPC) Co-Chair of the IEEE Biomedical Circuits and Systems Conference (BioCAS) 2026.



Prof. Inhee Lee, University of Pittsburgh, USA

[🏠 Link](#)

"The World's Smallest Computer and Its Applications"

Inhee Lee earned his B.S. and M.S. in electrical and electronic engineering from Yonsei University in 2006 and 2008, respectively. He obtained his Ph.D. in electrical and electronic engineering from the University of Michigan in 2014. From 2015 to 2019, he served as an assistant research scientist at the University of Michigan. In 2019, he became an assistant professor at the University of Pittsburgh. His research focuses on developing millimeter-scale or smaller sensing/computing systems for ecological, biomedical, and AI-of-things applications. Dr. Lee has served as a Technical Program Committee (TPC) Member for IEEE ISSCC, VLSI Symposium, CICC, A-SSCC, and CAS Analog Signal Processing.



Dr. Soyeon Um, MIT, USA

[in Link](#)

"Energy-Efficient In-Memory Computing Processors for AI Acceleration"

Soyeon Um received the B.S., M.S., and Ph.D. degrees from the School of Electrical Engineering, Korea Advanced Institute of Science and Technology (KAIST), Daejeon, South Korea, in 2020, 2021, and 2025, respectively. She is currently a Postdoctoral Associate at the Department of Electrical Engineering and Computer Science, Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT). Her current research interests include energy-efficient AI hardware design, with a particular focus on accelerators for deep neural networks, large language models and neuromorphic computing, as well as energy-efficient in-memory computing architectures.



Prof. Woo-Jun Choi, Yonsei University, South Korea

[🏠 Link](#)

"Compact, Energy-Efficient BJT-Based Temperature Sensor with Active Sampling Noise Cancellation"

Woojun Choi is an Assistant Professor in the Department of Integrated Display Engineering at Yonsei University, Seoul, Korea. He received his B.S. and Ph.D. degrees in Electrical and Electronic Engineering from Yonsei University. Prior to joining Yonsei University, he was an Assistant Professor at Kyung Hee University and a Postdoctoral Research Fellow at ETH Zürich. His research interests include high-performance and energy-efficient analog and mixed-signal integrated circuits for display driver ICs, biomedical systems, neural interfaces, and smart sensor applications. He received the IEEE ISSCC 2021 Takuo Sugano Award for Outstanding Far-East Paper and the IEEE SSCS Predoctoral Achievement Award.



Prof. Minyoung Song, DGIST, South Korea

[🏠 Link](#)

"Low-Power and Compact IR-UWB Transmitters with Advanced Spectral Shaping"

Minyoung Song received the B.S. and Ph.D. degrees in Electrical Engineering from Korea University, Republic of Korea, in 2006 and 2013, respectively. He is currently an Associate Professor with the Department of Electrical Engineering and Computer Science at DGIST, Korea. Before joining DGIST in 2023, he was a Senior Engineer at Samsung Electronics, where he developed analog and mixed-signal ICs. He then joined imec in the Netherlands, where he led the design of energy-efficient RFICs for biomedical and IoT applications. His current research focuses on analog, mixed-signal, and RF IC design for wireless communications and radar, as well as cryogenic CMOS circuits and interfaces for quantum sensing. He currently serves on the Technical Program Committee of ISSCC.



Prof. Muhammad Abrar Akram, Tampere University, Finland

[🏠 Link](#)

"From Reactive to Predictive Power Management: The Evolution of Intelligent Digital Low-Dropout Regulators for Future AI Systems"

Muhammad Abrar Akram is a Tenure-Track Assistant Professor in the Faculty of Information Technology and Communication Sciences at Tampere University, Finland. He received his B.S. from the University of Punjab, Pakistan, and his combined M.S./Ph.D. from Kangwon National University, South Korea. He has held research and faculty positions at New York University Abu Dhabi and Qatar University. His research focuses on analog and mixed-signal CMOS integrated circuits for power management, with recent work on learning-enabled digital voltage regulators. He is a recipient of the President's Award and Company Special Award from the Korean Semiconductor Industry Association (KSIA), and the Best Paper Award at ICEIC 2021.



Prof. Jae-Yoon Sim, POSTECH, South Korea

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"Integrated Cryo-CMOS Circuit Systems for Quantum Computing"

Jae-Yoon Sim received the B.S., M.S., and Ph.D. degrees from the POSTECH, in 1993, 1995, and 1999, respectively. From 1999 to 2005, he was a Senior Engineer with Samsung Electronics. Dr. Sim joined POSTECH in 2005 and is currently a professor. Since 2019, he has been the Director of the Scalable Quantum Computer Technology Platform Center. His research interests include sensor interface circuits, high-speed serial/parallel links, PLLs, data converters, AI accelerators and cryo-CMOS circuits for quantum computing. He received Takuo-Sugano Award in 2002, Jan Van Vessel Award in 2023 from ISSCC, and Scientist of the Month Award from Korea Ministry of Science and ICT in 2020. He had served on the Technical Program Committees for ISSCC, Symposium on VLSI Circuits, and ASSCC.



Prof. Woo-Seok Choi, Seoul National University, South Korea

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"Enabling High-Bandwidth, Noise-Resilient Die-to-Die Interfaces"

Woo-Seok Choi received the B.S. and M.S. degree in electrical engineering and computer science from Seoul National University, Seoul, Korea, in 2008 and 2010, respectively, and the Ph.D. degree in electrical and computer engineering from the University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign, IL, USA, in 2017. From 2018 to 2019, he was a postdoctoral fellow at Harvard University, Cambridge, MA, USA. Since 2020, Woo-Seok has been with the Department of Electrical and Computer Engineering of Seoul National University, where he is currently an associate professor. His research interests include designing energy-efficient high-speed wireline transceivers and low-noise clocking circuits.

